

Week-3 task 2

2. PASSWORD CRACKING WITH NETWORKWALKS TOOLS

Password cracking means finding or recovering a password from a protected file or stored data. In cyber-security, it is used to check whether a password is strong or weak. Common and short passwords can be cracked easily, which is why strong passwords are important.

Protected files such as PDF, ZIP, and Office documents use passwords for security. In this lab, we will first extract the password hash from a protected PDF using the **Hash Calculator**. After that, we will use the **Password Cracker** to try to recover the original password from the hash. Both tools work online through a web browser, so no installation is required.

This lab helps us understand the basic steps of password cracking and the importance of using strong passwords.

➤ STEP 1

Download the encrypted PDF file (My Locked PDF1.pdf) to your laptop from the lab page

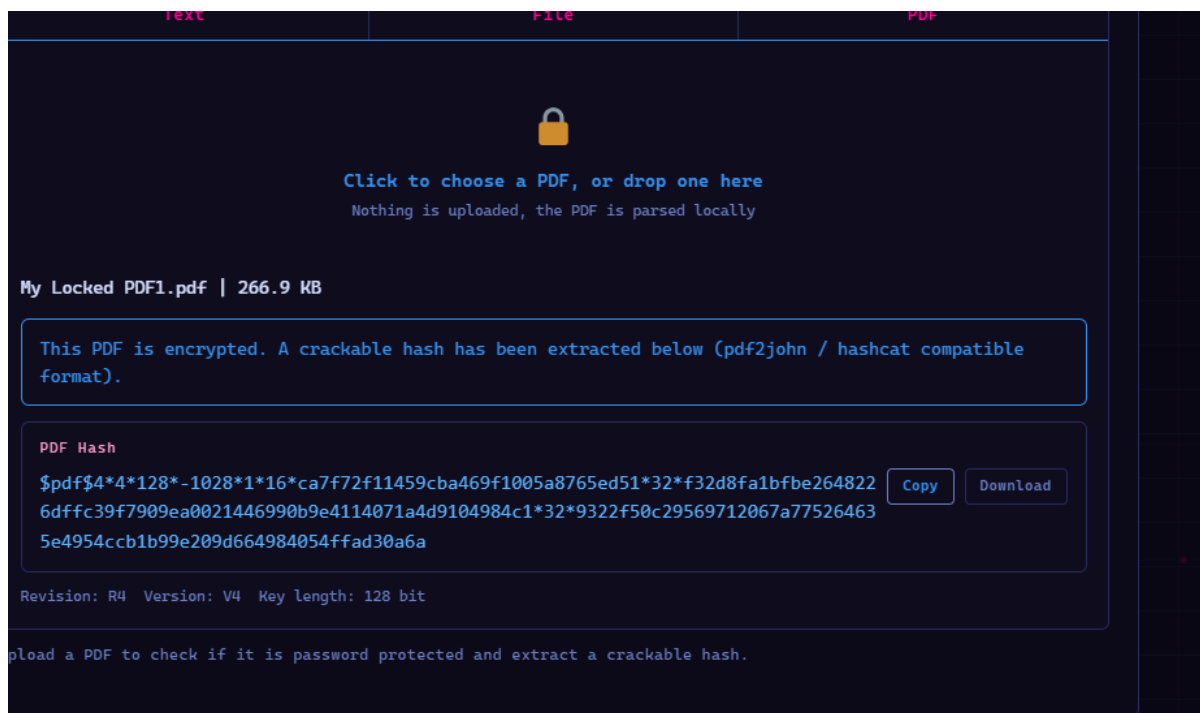
➤ STEP 2

Open the Networkwalks Hash Calculator in your web browser:

<https://networkwalks.com/hash-calculator/>

➤ STEP 3

Upload the locked PDF file to the Hash Calculator. The tool will read the file and give you the hash value that starts with \$pdf\$...



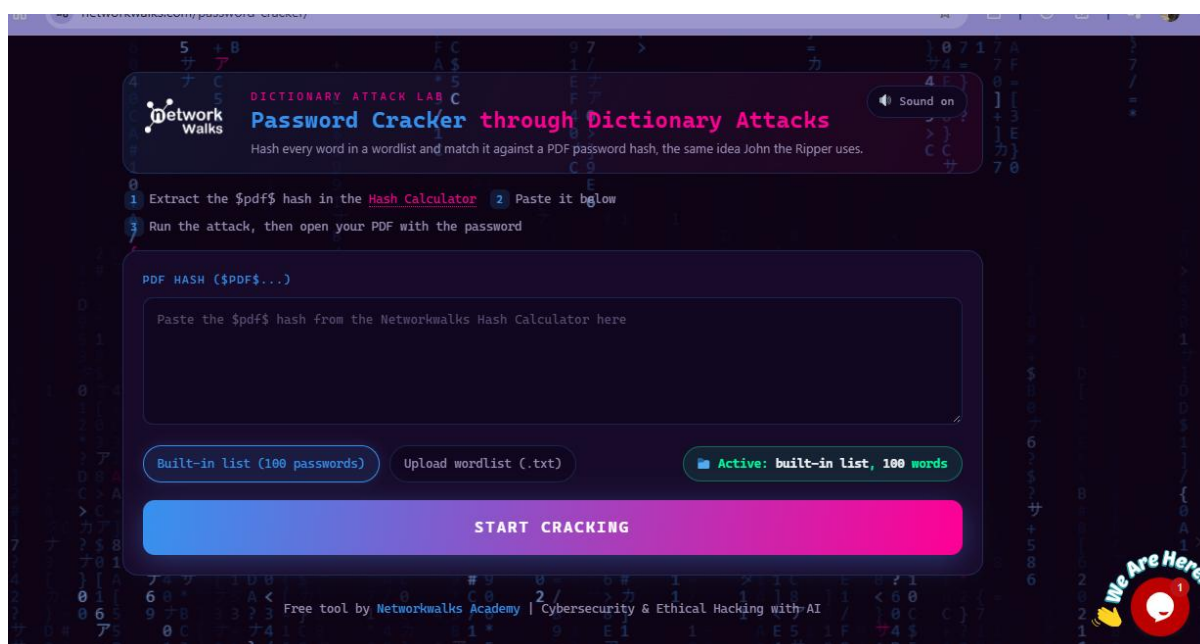
➤ STEP 4

Copy the complete hash starting from \$pdf\$. Do not miss any part of it.

➤ STEP 5

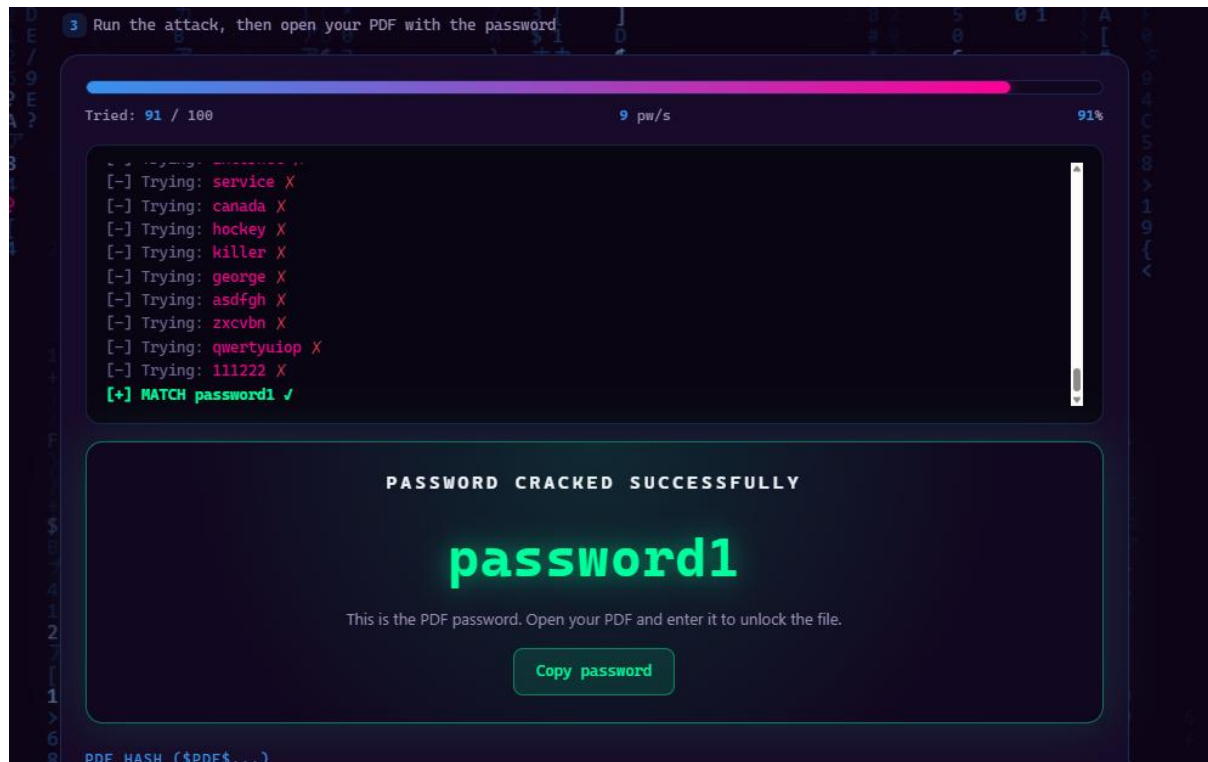
Open the Networkwalks Password Cracker in your web browser:

<https://networkwalks.com/password-cracker/>



➤ STEP 6

Paste the hash value into the Password Cracker and start the attack. The tool will try different passwords until it finds a match.



➤ STEP 7

Open the locked PDF file and enter the cracked password.

Enter password1 (which you have just cracked)

➤ STEP 8

The pdf will open and enjoy!!

